Sanitary & Phyto-sanitary (SPS) and Technical Barriers to Trade (TBT)

In response to question on India's SPS and TBT measures, India explained that specific trade concerns raised against India have been largely addressed. Regulations adopted in the past have been on the basis of scientific risk analysis.

Export Restrictions

There were some questions on India's use of export restrictions. India responded that export restrictions have been used on some occasions for purposes of domestic supply management, but these have been purely on a temporary basis. The ban on the export of rice and wheat had to be extended in 2009 due to a dislocation in production and again in 2010 due to the severest drought in the country in the last forty years. However, the export of wheat and non-basmati rice is now completely free. The export of basmati rice is and has always been free. Restrictions on cotton exports were imposed for only a brief period last year. Cotton yarn exports have been made completely free. Similarly, cotton is also freely exportable.

LOOKING BEYOND DOHA

At the Eighth Ministerial Conference (MC8) of the WTO in Geneva, December 15–17 , 2011 three Working Sessions were held in parallel (the NGOs were not allowed to take part in it), directed to ***three*** topics:

i. Importance of the Multilateral Trading System and the WTO;
ii. Trade and Development; and
iii. The Doha Development Agenda negotiations.

As had been expressly stated in the run-up to the **MC8** both from the WTO, from capitals, and in media reports, the ***Doha Round negotiations generally had come to an impasse.*** The impasse was made especially clear from the outcome of the so-called *Easter Package* in April 2011 – which comprised the collected reports of the WTO negotiating bodies in all the